SCTR'S PUNE INSTITUTE OF COMPUTER TECHNOLOGY, PUNE –411043
S.No.-27, Near Trimurti Chowk, Dhankawadi, Pune-411043

Department of Computer Engineering (S.Y. B. Tech.)

Lab Manual – Professional Development and Career Readiness (PDCR)

Course Code: 0308202. **Class**: SY. **Semester**: I
Course Name: Professional Development and Career Readiness

Assignment No. 1: Resume Skills

Title: Resume Skills

Problem Definition
A resume is a key tool for personal branding in the job market. This assignment introduces students to resume writing, highlights the differences between a CV, resume, and biodata, and develops an understanding of how to present their qualifications effectively. It also enables identification of common resume mistakes and encourages preparation of a resume that accurately reflects one's skills and achievements.

Objective
- To understand the importance of a resume in job applications.
- To differentiate between a CV, resume, and biodata.
- To identify and include the essential components of a good resume.
- To avoid common mistakes in resume preparation.
- To create a personalized, professional resume.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Microsoft Word / Google Docs / LaTeX (optional)

References
1. *Group Discussion & Interview Skills* – Priyadarshi Patnaik
2. *Communication Skills* – Sanjay Kumar & Pushpa Lata, Oxford University Press
3. *Developing Communication Skills* – Krishna Mohan & Meera Banerji, Macmillan India Ltd.

Rules/Instructions:

1. Research the latest resume formats (chronological, functional, hybrid).
2. Use Microsoft Word or any standard word processor to create your resume.
3. Include all essential sections: Contact Info, Objective, Education, Skills, Projects, Certifications, and Achievements.
4. Avoid grammatical/syntax errors and use a professional layout.
5. Submit a printed or digital version for review.
6. Peer review must be taken seriously—exchange resumes with at least one peer and give/receive feedback.

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Description / Theory

Difference between CV, Resume, and Biodata

Aspect	CV (Curriculum Vitae)	Resume	Biodata
Length	Detailed (2+ pages)	Concise (1-2 pages)	Very brief (often 1 page)
Focus	Academic qualifications, research	Job-specific skills, experiences	Personal information, used in govt jobs
Use Case	Academic positions, research grants	Corporate job applications	Marriage proposals, Govt jobs (India)

Essential Components of a Good Resume

1. Header: Name, contact number, email, LinkedIn profile
2. Career Objective: Brief summary of career goal
3. Educational Qualifications: Details with CGPA/percentage
4. Technical Skills: Programming languages, tools, platforms
5. Soft Skills: Communication, leadership, teamwork
6. Projects: Title, tools used, outcomes
7. Internships / Trainings: Organization, role, learning
8. Certifications: Online/offline certifications
9. Achievements: Awards, competitions
10. Hobbies/Interests: Relevant personal interests
11. Declaration: Confirmation of authenticity

Common Errors While Preparing a Resume

- Spelling and grammar mistakes
- Using unprofessional fonts or formatting
- Including irrelevant personal information
- Providing false or exaggerated claims
- Using generic objectives like "To work in a reputed company..."
- Not tailoring the resume for the specific job
- Ignoring ATS (Applicant Tracking System) keywords

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Self-Assessment / Activities - Assess educational, technical, and interpersonal profile
- Select a suitable resume format
- Draft and review resume based on best practices
- Correct identified errors in language and layout

Conclusion

This activity empowers students to represent themselves professionally through an effective resume. It builds awareness of their strengths, achievements, and areas of improvement while preparing them for internship and job opportunities. Students gain confidence in showcasing their skills clearly and professionally.

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Assignment No. 2: Interview Skills – Preparation and Presentation

Title: Interview Skills: Preparation and Presentation

Problem Definition
Students need to be aware of how to effectively prepare for various types of interviews. This includes research about companies, dressing appropriately, anticipating questions, and presenting oneself clearly and confidently.

Objective
- Understand types of interviews: Face-to-face, telephonic, video.
- Learn the STAR method for responding to questions.
- Practice verbal and non-verbal communication.
- Know the phases of the interview: opening, body, and closure.

Rules/Instructions:

1. Prepare for mock interviews in pairs or small groups.
2. Use STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) method to structure responses.
3. Dress formally during role play/mock interview sessions.
4. Practice all types of interviews – F2F, telephonic, and video.
5. Maintain proper etiquette: greeting, posture, listening actively, and thanking.
6. Each student must attend at least one mock interview.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Microsoft Word, Google Meet, Zoom (for mock interviews)

Description / Theory
The STAR technique is a structured manner of responding to behavioral interview questions by discussing the Situation, Task, Action, and Result. Understanding interview etiquette such as maintaining eye contact, appropriate dress code, and active listening is essential.

Activities
- Mock interviews based on job roles.
- Prepare responses using STAR method.
- Peer feedback and assessment.

Conclusion

Preparation and practice build the confidence required to face interviews successfully. This assignment helps students internalize key behaviors and techniques for effective self-presentation.

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Assignment No. 3: Interview Skills – Common Errors

Title: Interview Skills: Common Errors

Problem Definition
Many candidates fail interviews due to avoidable errors like lack of preparation, poor communication, or inappropriate attire. Recognizing and correcting these mistakes improves chances of success.

Objective
- Identify common interview mistakes.
- Learn to give clear and relevant answers.
- Demonstrate ideal body language and tone.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Video samples, mirror, mock interview setup

Rules/Instructions:

1. Observe and identify errors demonstrated during mock sessions.
2. Participate in role-plays highlighting both wrong and correct behaviors.
3. Avoid common errors: late arrival, poor grooming, vague responses, etc.
4. Practice correction strategies through feedback and self-reflection.
5. Record or reflect on your performance and improvement areas.

Description / Theory
Common errors include arriving late, failing to research the company, being too informal or too scripted, interrupting the interviewer, and giving vague answers.

Activities
- Analyze videos of bad interviews.
- Simulate interviews and document mistakes.
- Create a checklist for interview do's and don'ts.

Conclusion
Awareness of mistakes and corrective strategies ensures better preparation for real-life interviews. Students learn to adapt their behavior for professional environments.

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Assignment No. 4: Group Discussion Skills

Title: Group Discussion Skills

Problem Definition
Effective communication in group settings is crucial in academic and professional domains. Students must learn to express their opinions clearly, listen actively, and collaborate during group discussions.

Objective
- Understand GD structure and roles.
- Improve public speaking and listening skills.
- Foster teamwork and leadership through discussion.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Timer, topic list, evaluation sheet

Rules/Instructions:

1. Be prepared with knowledge of current topics (tech, social, ethical, etc.).
2. Speak clearly and confidently without interrupting others.
3. Maintain eye contact and use positive body language.
4. Begin with an introduction if possible and conclude with key points.
5. Listen actively and build on others' viewpoints.
6. Participate in at least one simulation and receive peer/instructor feedback.

Description / Theory
GD involves structured discussion where communication, logic, attitude, and team dynamics are evaluated. It helps in placement processes and overall confidence building.

Activities
- Practice GD on general and technical topics.
- Evaluate peers using rubrics.
- Reflect on participation style.

Conclusion
Students develop the ability to express and defend their views in a collaborative way. It fosters logical thinking, persuasion, and respectful disagreement.

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Assignment No. 5: Group Discussion – Common Errors

Title: Group Discussion: Common Errors

Problem Definition
Participation in GD can be hampered by errors such as interrupting others, deviating from the topic, or not contributing. Identifying these helps in developing professionalism.

Objective
- Recognize what hampers effective GD participation.
- Build awareness of GD etiquette and respect.
- Practice constructive feedback.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Sample GD videos, checklist, peer observation sheet

Description / Theory
Interrupting, being aggressive, not listening, or monopolizing conversation are common problems. Correct posture, tone, and teamwork are important.

Rules/Instructions:

1. Avoid dominant behaviour, interrupting, or going off-topic.
2. Don't be silent throughout the discussion; contribute constructively.
3. Practice managing time and giving others a chance to speak.
4. Focus on facts, avoid personal attacks or emotional outbursts.
5. Record and review mock GDs to identify and reflect on errors.

Activities
- GD simulations focused on avoiding errors.
- Peer observation and correction sessions.

Conclusion
Understanding and avoiding common GD mistakes prepares students to engage in effective group communication under pressure.

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Assignment No. 6: SWOT Analysis

Title: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats (SWOT) Analysis

Problem Definition
The students should be made aware of their goals, strengths and weaknesses, attitude, moral values, self-confidence, etiquette, non-verbal skills, and achievements through introspection. SWOT analysis helps in planning personal and professional growth.

Objective
- Inculcate the habit of self-assessment.
- Discover internal traits and external opportunities.
- Create strategies for overcoming threats and weaknesses.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Microsoft Word, Reflection journals

Rules/Instructions:

1. Perform honest self-introspection on your strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats.
2. Use a proper 2x2 SWOT matrix format.
3. Support your points with examples or brief explanations.
4. Keep your analysis confidential unless instructed otherwise.
5. Avoid vague traits—be specific and action-oriented.

Activities
- Self-evaluation and personality inventory.
- Preparation of SWOT matrix.
- Discussion and mentoring session.

SWOT Matrix Format

Strengths	Weaknesses
Opportunities	Threats

Conclusion

SWOT analysis promotes self-understanding and goal clarity. It is a foundational exercise for personal development and future readiness.

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Assignment No. 7: Exploring Career Opportunities

Title: Exploring Career Opportunities

Problem Definition
Students are often unaware of the diverse opportunities available in the job market. This activity introduces career paths, job roles, and self-employment options aligned with individual aspirations.

Objective
- Gain awareness of career landscapes.
- Identify self-potential and matching roles.
- Learn to use job portals, industry reports, and mentors.

Apparatus / Software Required
- Internet, career guidance platforms, job descriptions

Rules/Instructions:

1. Research 2–3 career options relevant to your stream or interest.
2. List the skills, qualifications, certifications, and pathways for each.
3. Explore both job roles and self-employment opportunities.
4. Use reliable sources like government portals, LinkedIn, and company websites.
5. Document findings clearly in tabular or structured format.
6. Create a basic action plan for your chosen career path.

Activities
- Research career paths and required skills.
- Map goals to opportunities.
- Create a career roadmap.

Conclusion
Career exploration helps students plan proactively and realistically. It builds motivation and clarity for future educational and employment decisions.